ROUTRIX TECHNOLOGIES LLC

AI Dev Kit: Start Here

From nothing installed to building your first project with a full team of AI specialists, in about 20 minutes.

What this is

A kit that gives your AI assistant a whole team of specialists: product planners, designers, programmers for every platform, testers, security reviewers, game developers and more. You describe what you want in plain words; the assistant brings in the right specialists and builds it with you.

What you need

- A Windows, Mac or Linux computer and an internet connection.
- One AI subscription:
  - **Claude** Pro or Max plan, for Claude Code, **or**
  - a **GitHub** account for GitHub Copilot (a free plan exists; a paid plan gives you much more use).
- About 20 minutes.

Set up, step by step

1 Install Visual Studio Code

Go to **code.visualstudio.com**, click **Download** and run the installer. On Windows, keep the defaults and also tick **"Add 'Open with Code' action"** and **"Add to PATH"** if offered. Open VS Code when it finishes.

2 Install Git (Windows only, recommended)

Git is how your work gets saved and can be undone. Go to **git-scm.com**, download Git for Windows and install it with the default options. On a Mac, skip this: if Git is ever needed, your Mac offers to install it.

3 Add your AI assistant to VS Code

Pick the one you have a subscription for.

Claude Code

1. Open Extensions: `Ctrl+Shift+X` (Mac: `Cmd+Shift+X`).
2. Search **Claude Code**, pick the one published by **Anthropic**, click **Install**.
3. Open it: click **Claude Code** in the status bar at the bottom right, or the spark icon at the top right of an open file.
4. Sign in with your Claude account when asked.

GitHub Copilot

1. Copilot is built into VS Code. Click the **Copilot icon** in the status bar at the bottom and choose **Use AI Features**, then sign in with GitHub.
2. No icon? Open Extensions (`Ctrl+Shift+X`), search **GitHub Copilot Chat** and install it.
3. Open the chat: `Ctrl+Alt+I` (Mac: `Ctrl+Cmd+I`).
4. At the bottom of the chat, set the mode to **Agent**.

4 Make a home for your projects

In VS Code choose **File, Open Folder**. Go to your user folder (Windows: `C:\Users\<your name>`, Mac: your home folder), create a new folder called **Projects**, select it and click **Select Folder** (Mac: **Open**). If VS Code asks whether you trust the authors, choose **Yes**: it is your own folder.

5 Point your AI at the kit

Open the AI chat (step 3) and paste this message exactly, then press Enter:

```
Install the AI Dev Kit from https://github.com/Routrix-Technologies-LLC/ai-dev-kit
Read AI-INSTALL.md in that repository and follow it.
```

Your assistant reads the kit's own install instructions and does everything: checks for Python (and offers to install it), downloads the kit, puts the agents, skills and instructions where they belong, and checks the result. It asks you two quick things first: how you want updates (we recommend **tell me and ask first**), and, for Claude Code, whether to make the thrifty **Sonnet** model your default (we recommend yes).

6 Approve its steps

The assistant asks before it runs commands or changes things on your computer. Each time, it tells you in a line what the step does. Read it, then click **Allow** (Claude Code: **Yes**; Copilot: **Allow** or **Continue**). If something sounds wrong, ask it: "*What does that do?*"

7 Reload VS Code when it says so

Press `Ctrl+Shift+P` (Mac: `Cmd+Shift+P`), type **Reload Window**, press Enter. Then open a new chat. The new agents and skills are now loaded.

8 Start building

In the chat, type `/kit-start` and say what you want to make. For example:

```
/kit-start I want a simple website for my side business.
/kit-start Help me make a small 2D game.
/kit-start I want a home server for my photos and backups.
```

It asks a few questions, sets up a project folder, picks the right team and tells you exactly what to type next.

You are set up

From here on, just talk to it. It brings in the specialists on its own, explains what it is doing, and asks before anything risky.

Keep costs down: the $20 plan is enough

- **Bigger is not better for everyday work.** Claude Opus or Fable and premium Copilot models use up your plan several times faster. The kit already uses the cheaper models. In Claude Code, type `/model sonnet` if it ever shows Opus or Fable.
- **New chat for each new task.** Hit a limit? Nothing is lost: Claude Pro refreshes after a few hours, Copilot's premium requests each month.

Commands worth knowing

TYPE	TO
`/kit-start`	Start any new project: an app, website, game, home lab project or security check.
`/app-help`	See where an app stands and what to do next.
`/kit-checkpoint`	Save your progress (so you can always get back to this point).
`/kit-homelab`	Work on servers, your network or self-hosted apps, with notes kept for you.
`/kit-help`	A tour of the kit, tips, and fixes for common problems.
`/kit-update`	Get the newest version of the kit. (If you chose "tell me and ask first", it will offer new versions on its own.)

Type `/` in the chat to see every skill.

Getting great results

- **Say the goal, not the steps.** "I want a page where my family can see whose turn it is to do chores" works better than "make an HTML file".
- **Ask why.** "Why did you pick that?" or "Explain that more simply." You will learn fast this way.
- **Ask for options.** "Give me two ways to do this and which you would pick."
- **Ask for proof.** "Show me it working" or "Run the tests."
- **Save often.** Say "checkpoint" whenever something works.
- **Steer freely.** "That's more than I need, make it simpler" is a perfectly good instruction.
- **Keep secrets out of chat and files.** Passwords and keys go in a password manager.

If something goes wrong

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
The `/kit-` commands do not appear	Reload VS Code (step 7) and open a new chat. Copilot: make sure the chat is in Agent mode.
"python is not recognized" or the Microsoft Store opens	Ask the assistant: "Install Python for me." Then close and reopen VS Code.
Claude Code says your plan does not include it	Claude Code needs a paid Claude plan (Pro or Max).
Copilot says you are out of requests	The free plan has a monthly limit; a paid Copilot plan raises it.
Anything else	Tell the assistant what you expected and what happened, and paste any error text. Or type `/kit-help`.

AI Dev Kit by Routrix Technologies LLC. github.com/Routrix-Technologies-LLC/ai-dev-kit. MIT License.